

CENTRIST SIMULATOR



Thank you very much to Indiepocalypse and to you, Reader, for giving me this opportunity for a post-mortem.

I hope that if you read these lines, you've cleared the game, maybe even saving everyone!

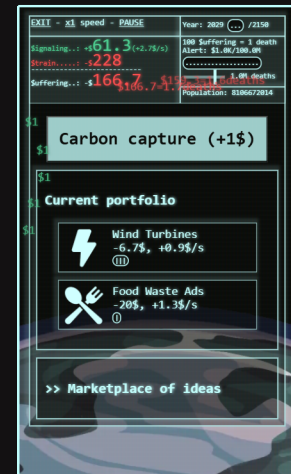
If not, try thinking outside the box. You need to do things that seem impossible ...

Speaking of which, I got stats for you! It appears that 75% of players gave up before finishing their first attempt, and only a third of the others actually clear the game.

It's not too surprising, but it really highlights the main challenge of designing this game. I've tried my best to make a solid and innovative idle game, but the actual game is of course the meta-game, closer to a puzzle game.

It turns out it's extremely hard to give hints to players without giving the solution away. The two main pieces of feedback I got were "too many hints" and "not enough hints". Oh, well...

It's especially tricky for my games which are trying to push the player to think by themselves and reclaim their agency. Emancipation has to come from within, otherwise you are still just following orders. Remember Bioshock?



This game was born out of a will to showcase how violent and **extreme** "normality" **already** is.

From this status-quo bias, it naturally expanded to the compassion fade bias and the identifiable victim bias.

I needed the player to have to make a huge crazy **radical** sacrifice that seemed unthinkable, just as it seems unthinkable to change our socio-economic system. Yet, if we don't, we know where the line will go...

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